

How To Really Sell On Amazon

The 7 Proven Steps to Help You Become
a Successful Amazon Seller

By
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The Amazon Selling Trainer

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Meet Alex Shelton – Digital Marketing Consultant

My Journey into Digital Marketing & Online Selling

Hello, my name is Alex Shelton and I am a Digital Marketing Consultant, Partner at Shelton Associates & Founder of the AMZ Business Academy. Sounds great, but what do I actually do? Basically, I help companies to set up and sell their products on Amazon and help companies that are already selling on Amazon to increase their sales. In a lot of cases, those sales can be very significant on Amazon, ranging from a few thousand pounds a month to £300K a month and more. Without sounding too much like Liam Neeson though, *I have built a particular set of skills when it comes to Amazon Selling which I use to help companies and individuals who are new to Amazon Selling to create their very own Amazon Business!*

The companies I work with on a 1-2-1 basis, are involved in a wide range of sectors including global consumer electronic brands, record producers, giftware manufacturers, global workwear manufacturers, sports equipment companies, electric radiator manufacturers, medical product suppliers, Pet food manufacturers, the list goes on! *Also, a lot of people come to me who are just starting out, some have a product they want to launch and others, maybe like you, don't have a product, but just want to start their own Amazon Business...*

How I got into Selling on Amazon

So, how did I actually get into all of this Amazon stuff? Well, 6 or 7 years ago a client came to me who wanted help with their marketing to launch a new product, a brilliant product as well, really niche. After a few meetings with the client we decided that I would sell the product in my own right as a distributor and so my Amazon adventure began.

My obvious thoughts here at this stage were OK, I know a lot about selling through websites, I can do that, I have excellent skills when it comes to social media advertising but what about Amazon? Is it even possible to sell this brand new product on Amazon (maybe a bit like you are now thinking about your own products), how does Amazon even work? Do I need to contact them, do they need to inspect the product etc, etc. All of these questions I had which, to be honest, seem a little silly now!

So, I started looking into it a bit more and what did I find? Lots and lots and lots of online videos! Wow! People saying different things, people claiming to be the best at this and the best at that, 6, 7, 8 figure businesses, my goodness it just went on and on and on! There's even more out there now! I will dive into this a little later on but my aim here is to show you how to painlessly and practically sell on Amazon!

Anyway, I was patient, some videos were useful and a lot of 'experts' were not, to put it bluntly, that expert. I basically learnt the hard way. I learnt by doing it all myself, making plenty of mistakes along the way because the platform for a beginner, in my opinion, is

not as intuitive as you might think. One thing particularly annoyed me when going through everything you might be going through now. I was fed up of buying a “300 stage” selling system or a “free” 48-page guide on something that didn’t actually show me how to sell on Amazon!

There are also videos out there that are far too complex for a beginner. I was fed up and decided to learn the hard way, which yes, took me longer than I would have liked, but I knew at some point I was going to write this book and ‘make it painless for others to sell on Amazon’.

So, this book is for you to keep and refer to forever and I know I’m going to say this but it does have some really, really useful information in it for anyone looking to learn ‘How to Really Sell on Amazon’ and to create their own Amazon Business.

*Having said that though, at the end of this book there is a link to buy my online intensive training package ‘**How to Create Your Very Own Amazon Business**’ and this can be purchased at an exclusively discounted price, just for those of you who have purchased this book!. I’m being completely clear with you now because that is what I absolutely hated when going through this process myself with endless up-sells and free bonus packages! I will obviously cover everything that is included in the course later in this book, but the online course naturally goes into more depth and is put together by myself to actually show you how to create your own Amazon Business in the videos, based on my experience with my Amazon Business and working with many clients on Amazon.*

You will naturally though, as you will have read this book, already be in a great position to launch your Amazon Business!

So, after learning ‘the hard way’, after a couple of years, I was able to bring Amazon Training into our Marketing Consultancy Business which is what I really love to do. Yes, these skills allowed me to buy my first house when I was just 21 years old, but I’ll be honest, I love standing up, presenting and showing people what I’ve learnt, why? Because when you see the results for someone else there is nothing quite like it for me.

When you take Businesses (which have great products but perhaps are not achieving the sales levels they should be) from a standing start on Amazon to up to £300k a month in sales, let me tell you it is very rewarding! I love to help clients’ Businesses thrive and as Marketing Consultants that’s what we want to do... we want to now help your new Amazon Business thrive and prosper.

Clearly, these results are not typical, but as with most things, the more you put into it, the more you tend to get out of it! Also, factors such as the products you are selling, changing market conditions, the level of competition etc., will all determine how successful your Amazon business will be, but it is nice to know what is possible!

Creating a Business from scratch is scary, yes, there is a lot to think about, so much to do, so many worries, but with an Amazon Business it’s not always like that.

In fact no. It shouldn't be like that. It should actually be quite an exciting time!

My advice if you are starting out from scratch is to take this process very seriously but also enjoy it. Take your time, don't quit your job straight away or drop out of University (believe me I've had these type of phone calls before).

Learn the essential selling skills I'm going to show you to become an effective Amazon Seller and yes, I want you to make a lot of money (and that can happen very quickly and does for a lot of our clients) but it's almost inevitable that you will make mistakes along the way.

So, learn the system with me, think like the Business Owner that you are about to become and don't jump into anything without a plan. Remember, as a wise man once said 'a goal without a plan is just a wish'.

What makes us so different from anyone else out there

I'm hoping by now that you're starting to see that I am a lot different from the other 'Amazon Selling Experts' or 'Online Money Millionaire Makers' etc. etc. out there.

I am a professional Marketing Consultant, a Partner in a Professional Marketing Consultancy which I've worked in for almost ten years. My Dad set up Shelton Associates over 25 years ago to help small and medium-

sized businesses develop Marketing Plans (you see now where I got the planning bit from. It's in my genes!).

I joined the business almost ten years ago to help develop clients and work with them, particularly on the social media side, which at that time was a relatively new concept for Businesses.

Social Media advertising is an important part of what I do for clients. It's powerful stuff and something we will discuss later in this book and maybe bring into your Amazon Business in the future.

So, obviously finding a good product was perhaps a little easier for me than most given my background, but I've built relationships with many manufacturers on the way and I've also learnt the process of manufacturing/sourcing items overseas.

So being able to work with clients and private sellers looking to create a new business has just been incredible for me and I hope you can tell that I absolutely love this process we're going to go into, and I'm sure that you will too.

Setting up a Traditional Business v Setting up an Amazon Business

I hope that you're starting to see that there is a lot of potential to become an Amazon Seller with the right strategy in place, but if you're still a little sceptical then here are just a few things to consider.

If you already have products to sell and are looking at Amazon as another ‘direct route to market’ then the areas we go through in this book still apply to you, I am helping you to create a New Amazon Business.

You might have decided that being your own boss is the way forward and I don’t disagree with you on that, there’s nothing quite like it but think about the expense you have to go to and the capital you need to start a Traditional Business.

You may need premises, you will probably need suppliers and equipment, insurance, you may need to employ people, you may need extra PCs, the list goes on. With an Amazon Business, however, to get going all you really need is a laptop and a good internet connection!

I started out selling products from my garage (again, I learnt the hard way). But with an Amazon Business, you might really never actually see the products you sell. Sounds a little crazy but it’s perfectly normal in the Amazon Selling World!

So, a PC, Wi-Fi, Business Owner mind-set, that’s initially all you need to take the first step. Let’s get going...

The Power of Amazon Selling

An Introduction to Amazon-A few Facts and Figures

Right then, let's get into the power behind this global giant Amazon... Mintel, the leading Retail Intelligence Organisation, estimates that almost 90% of UK shoppers use Amazon. If you don't use Amazon to buy then I would be very shocked!

Mintel also estimates that just over a quarter of the adult population in the UK is signed up to Amazon Prime, which is just incredible! These numbers will only grow as well, I'm sure of it.

So, if you can find a product or products that are unique and there is a demand for them, then there are more than enough people you can be selling them to on this global machine!

The thing I love about Amazon is that it is a trusted source and a place where buyers nowadays expect to find the item they are looking for or similar. Think about how many times you've bought from Amazon. I bet you couldn't count the number of purchases you've made for yourself or your family members!

But why is Amazon so trusted? Well, a big part of the reason is how well Amazon treats its customers. Free next-day delivery in a lot of cases with 'Prime' – Why would you not use your Amazon Prime subscription instead of 'the other' website that wants to charge, say

£5.99 for delivery and it's going to take 5-7 working days! 'Amazon Prime' is basically a subscription-based service where Members receive benefits which include free fast shipping for eligible purchases.

We as modern-day, savvy online buyers want things now and we want excellent customer service and we are not happy if we don't get that. Amazon really has set the standard for online sellers. If you are selling a product through an unknown website, do you think customers expect to receive the same high standard, probably not. In my opinion, you can't beat Amazon so join them!

Have you Heard of Fulfilment by Amazon (FBA)?

Oh boy, if you haven't, then you're really going to love this part! This is where Amazon has just transformed the way we sell online.

So, as (future) Amazon Sellers we can send our products to Amazon's Fulfilment Centres and when orders come in, Amazon then distributes the products to customers for us! It is brilliant, I mean really brilliant.

Remember when I said you might never actually see the products you're selling... this is why! There's a good chance that your products will go straight from the Manufacturer to an Amazon Fulfilment Centre and then straight out to the customers when they buy. Impressive stuff eh?

It's not like the old days of storing products in your garage or in a warehouse somewhere. Amazon stores and handles your products for you!

Of course, there is work to be done to get to that point but you can see why I mentioned that to run an Amazon Business you might only need your laptop, internet connection and somewhere comfortable to work from!

Finding the product or products is a massive part of all of this, but when you have done that part it takes the pain out of having to send products out to customers yourself every time an order comes in, which most of us are not set up to do. We cover this in more detail in *'The 7 Proven Steps to Becoming a Successful Amazon Seller'*, later on in this book.

Selling Your Products all over the World!

I am jumping ahead here a little, but with FBA (Fulfilment by Amazon) Amazon can even ship your products to customers around the world. They have lots of different marketplaces which include:

Amazon.co.UK

Amazon.com (US)

Amazon.CA (Canada)

The list goes on!

We are going to be taking things one step at a time here, but I just want to make you aware that being an Amazon Seller does not restrict you to one country.

If it makes sense you could be selling across Europe, for example, in no time at all and Amazon could be distributing your orders out to these customers for you and handling the customer service side of things! So, you can be exporters too at the flick of a button!

Getting Started as an Amazon Seller

Create an Amazon Growth Plan

Plan, Plan, Plan! OK, I know I've mentioned it before and that's because I can't stress the importance of it enough. If you don't have a written plan or a formal document then you don't have a plan.

Your Amazon Plan needs to set out what you want to achieve and how you are going to get there. It will also include an 'Action Plan' so you know exactly what you're going to do and when you're going to do it to achieve your goals.

So, once again, this part of the process is crucial and I believe it has always been the key to differentiating Shelton' Associates as a Marketing Consultancy as people often overlook the importance of a Plan.

If you have your products ready to sell, then in a lot of cases you can start listing your products on Amazon pretty quickly, but my advice would be to not rush into it.

It's very easy on Amazon to list products without doing your research beforehand and then getting extremely fed up when no or very few sales are coming in. I get that quite a bit when I am asked to work with new clients or running Public Seminars *"well, I listed my products on Amazon but it didn't work for me!!."*

The next stage would be for me to “jump in” and have a look at how they have listed the product and let me tell you 9 times out of 10 it is because they didn’t do their research beforehand in their Amazon launch plan!

If you don’t have products ready to sell then I am going to take the view that you are starting out from scratch and will need to ‘source’ products from Manufacturers or other suppliers to send to Amazon.

No need to worry, this is what a lot of Amazon Sellers do and I am going to take you through this process. If you do have products to sell (e.g. you make products from home or store your products ready to send to customers) then the Amazon system I will go through is for you as well. It just means that you will be shipping these products to Amazon yourself instead of the Manufacturer/Supplier doing it for you.

You don’t have to go down the FBA (Fulfilment by Amazon) route by the way. If you recall, this is where you send your products to Amazon and they distribute the product to the customer for you. You can send products to customers yourself if you want to but let’s cross that bridge when we come to it.

Let’s Think about Finding Products to Sell on Amazon

I am going to go into this in a lot more detail later on in the *‘Proven 7 Steps to Becoming a Successful Amazon Seller’*, but there are tools out there to help you with

product research. Some good, some not so good, but you can also do your own research to see what the competition is like and to see if there is a demand for the type of product you have in mind.

To complicate matters there doesn't have to be a high level of demand at the moment either, as some products that were once completely unique and unheard of sell really, really well on Amazon. You are basically 'satisfying a latent demand' with these types of products.

So, perhaps jot down a few ideas you might have for products, to begin with. You don't have to go with my advice on this one but for me personally, I would avoid electronic items – I believe the market is very saturated and things can go wrong with electrical items as well!

I know I mentioned right back at the beginning that I have worked with a global electronics brand, but they had that advantage of being a well-known organisation and they manufacture themselves. For most of us, we don't want to take unnecessary risks at this stage... you can see I'm not one for taking leaps without planning!

Other things I would probably stay away from are products that break easily such as mirrors for example... I spoke to a mirror manufacturer not long ago who mentioned almost 40% of his stock is damaged in transit! So, anything that can break easily is a 'no go' for me.

Clothing is something I would think long and hard about, as well. Even though I have worked with people who have made a lot of money selling clothing on Amazon you do tend to get a lot of returns and I personally wouldn't want that hassle.

Other things to consider are the size and weight of the product as the bigger and heavier the item is, the higher your FBA (Fulfilment by Amazon) Fee will be.

Subscribe & Save

A really interesting point to mention, at this stage, is 'Subscribe & Save'. You may have seen this option when purchasing some products on Amazon and what it basically means is that the buyer has the option to set up regularly scheduled deliveries and earn savings with 'Subscribe & Save'. You will need to meet Amazon's criteria to be eligible for this service.

What this means for us as Sellers is repeat orders and ongoing income! 'Subscribe & Save' won't work for all products, however, if you can think of a product that people would be keen to order on a subscription you may be on to a winner! Things like toothbrushes, toothpaste and hand soap are all essential items people need. What about hair dye, razors or even tissues?

To be clear I'm not saying that these are the products to start 'sourcing', however, they are products people purchase on a regular basis which could possibly generate repeat orders and on-going income from Amazon customers.

Your packaging can also really make a difference to your product, going that extra mile with your packaging can make your product stand out from the crowd.

Nowadays people love a product that's a little bit different and come in a unique, possibly made to look 'handcrafted' box! If you order an 'everyday' product for yourself which arrives in very unique packaging it almost becomes a gift!

OK then, for now, just jot down a few initial thoughts below about what products you could be selling on Amazon! I'll be giving you some more ideas and tools to help with all of this later on but it's a good starting point!

What type of Products Could I Potentially Sell on Amazon?

- 1.....
- 2.....
- 3.....
- 4.....
- 5.....

Now, you can sell products that are already being sold on Amazon but this tends to put you in a position of being in a 'price war' which nobody really wants! By

this, I mean selling the *exact* product and not a type of product!

So, on my training courses I certainly never say ‘don’t sell an exact product that is already on Amazon’ but I like to remind everyone that it can come with these drawbacks.

Winning The Buy Box

If you are selling a product that already exists on Amazon and there are other sellers selling the exact same item, they call this ‘Competing for the Buy Box’.

Your aim is to ‘Win The Buy Box’. But what does the ‘Buy Box’ actually look like? Well, it is essentially the ‘Add to Basket’ section you see when you go to order a product on Amazon.

One seller will have won the ‘add to basket’ and underneath you can usually see other sellers that are selling the same product but aren’t as likely to get the sales or as many at least, because they haven’t won the Buy Box. This is really important to being successful on Amazon.

You can see here that one Seller has WON the '**Buy Box**'. If I click on to 'Add To Basket' only one seller will get the sale.

You can also see that the product is '**Fulfilled by Amazon**' so the seller has gone down the FBA (Fulfilment By Amazon) route.

Underneath all of this you can see 3 other sellers selling the exact same item but have not won the '**Buy Box**'.

£28.99

& FREE Delivery . [Delivery Details](#)

Arrives: **July 21 - 22** [Details](#)

Fastest delivery: **Tomorrow**

Order within 7 hrs 53 mins [Details](#)

In stock.

Quantity: 1 ▾



Add to Basket



Buy Now



Secure transaction

Sold by _____ and
Fulfilled by Amazon.

☐ Yes, I want a free trial with **FREE**
Premium Delivery on this
order.
amazon prime

☐ Add gift options

Select delivery location

Add to List

New (3) from
£28.99 + FREE Shipping



So, how do you ‘Win The Buy Box’? Well, it’s an automated system but the price is a big factor here but not the only factor! Other things that are taken into account are things like Customer Reviews and how quickly you can get the product to the customer. ‘Prime’ products also tend to ‘Win The Buy Box’.

So that’s the situation you are stuck in when selling products that are already on Amazon. It’s a competition to beat the other sellers.

People who buy products in retail stores (quite often at a clearance price) and then sell those same products on Amazon often find themselves in the situation of ‘Competing for the Buy Box’ with other sellers. They call this process “Retail Arbitrage”.

There are plenty of Wholesale websites out there if you choose to go down the Wholesale route!

If you have a product ready to sell that does already exist on Amazon then there are ways around having to ‘Compete for the Buy Box’. One option would be to ‘Bundle’ your product with another product.

For example, if you are selling a Stapler that already exists on Amazon, you could ‘Bundle’ the Stapler with some staples and that would then become a new product listing and you are saving the customer the hassle of having to buy two separate products.

Another option would be to sell in a different Amazon Marketplace where the product isn’t already listed. For

example, if the board game you want to sell is already listed on Amazon.co.uk, however, it's not available on Amazon.au (in Australia) you could choose to concentrate on the Australian market and have your products sent directly to an Amazon Fulfilment Centre in Australia.

The process I am going to mainly focus on here is finding 'product types' that you will get manufactured for you by third parties, which you will then brand as your own. They call this "Private Labelling" and you can then make your products 'Prime' products, by using the FBA (Fulfilment by Amazon) service.

Sending your products to an Amazon Fulfilment Centre means that your products become 'Prime' products. I have to be clear though that with FBA, Amazon is not purchasing your products from you. They are simply storing the products in their warehouse and distributing them to the customers for a fee. They call this an "FBA fee" and the fee can vary depending on the size and weight of your product.

I don't want to confuse you at this stage, but there may come a time when Amazon wants to purchase the products from you directly and at that stage, decisions will need to be made! They will invite you to use a different platform called a 'Vendor Central Account'. That is for another day though...

Don't Make This Mistake!

Let's talk about mistakes to avoid then when going through this process. I've certainly covered a few already, but one of the key mistakes made when people do have products manufactured/supplied for them is that they order too many to start with.

Then the products might not sell because there is no demand or they haven't done their research beforehand or learnt how the Amazon Selling platform works. So, in the end, they just end up with stock that isn't moving and by the way that's the last thing you want because Amazon charges FBA storage fees if the products don't sell after a while, as well as having your hard-earned money tied up in stock.

I have worked with Businesses who sell heavy items such as electric radiators or heavy sports-related products and when it came down to looking at the FBA side it just wasn't worth it to them, because the FBA fee meant that their margin was not sufficient.

So, they had to make a decision to not sell the item using FBA. Small, lightweight items that are not too cheap or not too expensive are good product types to be thinking about. Most FBA sellers I work with aim for a product sales price between £10 and £50. A good margin is also vital but let's come on to that in a bit!

Contacting Manufacturers/Suppliers

Contacting Manufacturers/Suppliers at the start to source products can seem quite scary to some people, but, as we have discussed, you're going to have an Amazon Plan in place and with an Amazon Plan you should know your goal and how much you have to spend so this bit shouldn't be overly difficult. It is just about building relationships with the right people.

I am going to talk you through this process in **Step 1 of my 7 Proven Steps to Becoming a Successful Amazon Seller.**

Learning the Amazon Seller Platform

What I can't stress enough, however, is that first of all, you need to start learning how the Amazon Selling Platform works and there is a lot to it!

You need to understand the platform fully before 'playing around with things' because you could then be in the position I was in years ago (and many of the people who come to us are in now) of searching for video after video, trying to 'Open Cases' with Amazon, scanning forums etc. to find out answers!

The Amazon Seller platform is not quite as intuitive as you might think, so if you fully understand the platform, Amazon fees, listing your products, optimisation, FBA, reviews, getting paid etc. from day one, then you will be in a far better position to start driving your new Amazon Business forward, successfully!

Your Next Step to Amazon Success

What’s your End Goal?

By now, I hope that you are excited and ready to start creating your own Amazon Business and understand the importance of planning ahead so you know where you’re going, what you want to achieve and how you are going to get there.

Let me just ask you a quick question, what is your long-term goal here? Is it to become financially free? Is it to sell your Amazon Business? Is it so you can pay off your Mortgage? Whatever your end goal is, just make a note of it below and don’t forget to date it! Having a goal will give your Amazon Business value to you and your Amazon Plan will help you to achieve this dream.

What is my Long-Term Goal?

.....
.....

Date:

You will be coming back to this section a few times so keep it safe!

Let’s get into it in detail then...

7 Proven Steps to becoming a Successful Amazon Seller

STEP 1 - FINDING YOUR PRODUCTS

If you are already an established business and you know the products you will be selling on Amazon, or you are currently in the process of having a product Manufactured for you then, that's great but I wouldn't move onto the next step just yet!

There are a whole range of online tools to help you find products to sell on Amazon. These tools give you a good idea of the number of sales every product on Amazon is achieving and the types of products you could sell.

These tools are also great to help you to set sales targets for your new Amazon Business.

So, even if you know the products you want to sell, it is a good idea to use these valuable tools to research and find out how much others who are selling these types of products are making! A couple of options out there and the ones I tend to use are Jungle Scout and Helium 10.

There is a whole range of useful tools available within Jungle Scout. There is a 'Supplier Database' to help with finding suppliers, an 'Inventory Manager' to help with demand, a 'Product Database' to help generate product ideas etc. I really like the Jungle Scout Chrome Extension (which means that you need to be using Google Chrome) and this helps to identify estimated revenue on products when doing a search within an Amazon Marketplace.

If you have written a few product ideas down previously in this book, you may be surprised at the level of sales that people are making with these products. You can identify the estimated 30 Day Gross Revenue on each product by using the Jungle Scout Extension.

On the other hand, you may see that sales are very low, so you might make a decision to rule that idea out and move onto the next one!

I like to come up with my own ideas and use Jungle Scout in this way.

Have a look at an example of Jungle Scout (Chrome Extension) in action.

HAVE A LOOK AT AN EXAMPLE OF JUNGLE SCOUT IN ACTION

I have searched within Amazon.co.uk for 'Shampoo'

Jungle Scout displays the Average Monthly Sales, Average Sales Rank, Average Price and Average number of Reviews for that keyword.

Average Monthly Sales		Average Sales Rank		Average Price		Average Reviews	
2,975		7,866		£10.74		752	

#	Actions	Product Name	Brand	Price	Mo. Sales	D. Sales	Mo. Revenue	Re
1		TRESemme Smooth Salon Silk Shampoo...	TRESemme	£2.00	5,180	230	£10,360	1,4
2		L'Oreal Elvive Dream Lengths Long Hair S...	L'Oreal Paris	£2.75	10,238	347	£28,155	91
3		Ogx Argan Moroccan Oil Shampoo for Dr...	Ogx	£3.46	7,416	291	£25,659	1,2
4		Faith in Nature Natural Grapefruit & Oran...	Faith in Nat...	£7.99	4,996	200	£39,918	1,1
5		Palmer's Coconut Oil Formula Shampoo ...	Palmer's	£2.79	2,160	68	£6,026	34
6		Bed Head by Tigi Urban Antidotes Recov...	TIGI Bed H...	£14.80	7,215	260	£106,782	3,2
7		Head & Shoulders Classic Clean Anti-Da...	Head & Sho...	£7.00	4,800	168	£33,600	81
8		VO5 Nourish My Shine Shampoo, Fresh A...	VO5	£6.00	1,310	43	£7,860	11
9		Herbal Essences Bio Renew Argan Oil of ...	Herbal Ess...	£13.35	1,973	47	£26,340	13

Importantly, Jungle Scout displays the Estimated 30 day Unit Sales, Estimated Daily Sales and Estimated 30 Day Gross Revenue on each product!

If you find a ‘product type’ to sell on Amazon, the key thing to consider here is the potential for long-term success by having a unique advantage over the competition.

So, if you launched the product today, do you have much competition on Amazon? If there isn’t much competition, then you perhaps have the room to increase your price! Also, look at the number of Sellers selling items that are similar to ‘yours’ and look at the ratings on these products that already exist on Amazon.

Then read the reviews and look at what people ‘like’ about the product and what people ‘don’t like’ as you don’t want to make the same mistakes that they have been making! If you are sourcing products from overseas from Alibaba, for example, it is important to note how many suppliers there are offering that product type.

If there are lots of suppliers, it tends to be easier for other people to source that product. If there are very few suppliers, though, you may have to pay more for the product.

Product Idea Tips for FBA (Fulfilment By Amazon)

If you don’t have an idea for a product, at this stage, then here are a few product ideas and tips to help you out and to get you thinking...

-Check out the ‘Amazon Best Sellers’ page to see the top-selling products on Amazon, as there might be a few ideas there...

-Make a list of Hobbies you enjoy – what products do you use for your hobbies and activities that you could possibly sell on Amazon?

-Embarrassing Products – People shop online for products they don't want to go into the shop for!

-What about Organic Products, Vegan Products, Eco-friendly products these are all big areas at the moment!

-You could even create a product that nobody has heard of yet! You would potentially be 'satisfying a latent demand' with this type of product.

-Or just go for quantity! Something very basic that Amazon could be shipping out like there's no tomorrow! If there is a lot of competition though and your product is easy to copy, then this particular product may not be a long-term opportunity.

-Jungle Scout & Helium 10

A key point to mention is that great looking packaging can make your product really stand out from the crowd!

These are just a few tips to get the 'juices flowing' if you don't already have a product in mind but it's important to consider the potential for long-term success with your chosen product. High sales volumes are great but what is the competition like, can you compete on price, what is the size and weight of the product (important for FBA) etc.

Contacting Manufacturers/Suppliers (UK & Overseas)

When running my 1-2-1 training programmes, we never rule out getting products manufactured for us here in the UK, it tends to be slightly more expensive but certainly makes things easier to manage.

You could visit Trade Shows in the country you live in or even further afield! It sounds obvious but if you think of a product you want to sell, just do a Google search!

For example, if you are looking for a Manufacturer producing Vitamins just search for “Vitamins Manufacturer” in Google or “Vitamins Manufacturer Private Label”. You can email them, call them or even use a platform such as LinkedIn to contact them.

You can of course, as well, have a look at a range of websites to identify Manufacturers/Suppliers overseas, which might include the following, depending on where you are based:

Alibaba.com
Made-in-china.com
DHgate.com
Globalsources.com

Some key things to consider when dealing with a new Manufacturer/Supplier are:

- Price Quotes for Minimum Order Quantities
- Product Specifications (material, size, colour and weight)
- Quality Control
- Idea of costs for Packaging/re-branding
- Lead Time

- The weight and size of the product (important for FBA!)
- Payment methods
- Pro Forma Invoice
- Shipping (Air or Sea)
- Experience of sending to Amazon Fulfilment Centres

Asking these key questions is a hugely important part of the process of identifying products to sell and will give you a good idea of the costs involved. I would typically contact several Manufacturers/Suppliers and put all of this information together in a spreadsheet or similar so it is easy for you to find the details of the Manufacturers you've contacted.

Remember you have to consider the unit cost (cost of each product), you have to consider your referral fee (Amazon's percentage charge) plus the FBA (Fulfilment by Amazon) fee and the cost of shipping the product to Amazon's Fulfilment Centres.

To work out your 'Profit Margin' per unit you would need an idea for the 'Sale Price' and then subtract the unit cost, Amazon referral fee, shipping costs and FBA fee to give you your 'Profit Margin'.

So, take a look at similar products already listed on Amazon to give you an idea of how much you could potentially sell your product for, follow the calculation below and then you will have a good idea of your profit margin. You can use the Amazon FBA Profitability Calculator to help with this and I'd also add this information to a spreadsheet.

Sale Price (Minus) Unit Cost (Minus) Shipping Costs
(Minus) Amazon Referral Fee (Minus) Amazon FBA Fee =
PROFIT MARGIN

To give you a percentage just divide the Profit Margin by the Sales Price x 100. An example might be that your Profit Margin is £5 and the Sales Price £20 so just divide 5 by 20 x 100 and this would give you a percentage Profit Margin of 25%.

Really detailed and interesting stuff here, so I would make sure that you keep track of this information as you go! Your Spreadsheet then might include the following headers:-

- Product
- Manufacturer/Supplier
- Unit Price
- MOQ (Minimum Order Quantity)
- Size of Product (Dimensions)
- Weight
- Amazon Referral Fee
- FBA Fee
- Shipping Costs
- Unit Profit Margin
- Profit Margin Percentage
- Additional Notes (I would copy and paste the details of the conversation you had with the supplier here)

If you are having concerns about Contacting Manufacturers/Suppliers, remember you will be doing things slowly here and there really isn't a lot to be worried about at this stage if you are clear about your requirements.

Remember when contacting Manufacturers, ask to request samples, negotiate the MOQ (Minimum Order Quantity), ask if you have the rights to add your logo/barcode to the packaging, are they familiar with packaging items for Amazon FBA and talk about building a long-term relationship with them.

Another question to add to the list when contacting Manufacturers/Suppliers, but nevertheless an important one, is whether they will include the Barcode on the product for you. Amazon recommends GS1 Barcodes.

So, ask the Manufacturer/Supplier if your Barcode can be included on the product packaging. It's a good idea to refer to the 'FBA Product Barcode Requirements' Page in your Seller Central Account to ensure that you are in line with Amazon's requirements.

Requesting a Sample

In terms of requesting a product sample, I would personally, first of all, have the sample sent to my home or office so I could inspect it to make sure that the product is as agreed.

I may even have my first order sent directly to me so I can be sure they are of the same quality before I ask the Manufacturer/Supplier to send the products directly to Amazon's Fulfilment Centres.

A quick reminder that you can fulfil your orders yourself if you want to, you don't have to have the products sent to Amazon's Fulfilment Centres, in which case when you place an order you will have it sent directly to you. It's also worth checking to see if the suppliers will refund the fees you paid for the samples if you proceed with an order.

Terms you Need to be aware of...

Here are a few terms you should ideally be familiar with when it comes to the shipping process.

Delivered Duty Paid – This term means that the Manufacturer/Supplier is responsible for getting the products to you or the Amazon Fulfilment Centre.

Free on Board – This means that you, the buyer, are responsible for the products when the shipment reaches the nearest port.

Ex-Works – This term means that you, the buyer, are responsible for the shipment once it has left the factory.

It's probably worth asking the Manufacturer/Supplier if they can provide quotes for all three of the above options. Typically, Delivered Duty Paid will be more expensive, however, this may be the right option for you. Just be aware of possible situations though where the supplier may not actually pay all relevant taxes and you may ultimately become liable.

If you do go with Free on Board or Ex-Works a freight forwarder will be needed to make shipping arrangements for you. Of course, if you end up purchasing from a UK or local Manufacturers/Supplier, these approaches won't be necessary, but they may be useful for you in the future.

Depending on where you are based, you may find it useful to talk to your local Chamber of Commerce or Department of International Trade about these options.

What is a Pro-Forma Invoice?

A Pro-Forma Invoice is an initial Bill of Sale sent to you, the buyer, before the shipment.

It will typically include details of the items purchased, quantity, transport charges, shipping terms, shipping weight, packaging specifications etc.

By this point you will have been 'back and forth' with the Manufacturer so you need to make sure that you both agree on everything that is presented in the pro-forma invoice.

Double-check everything here! There will have been a good bit of communication so make sure that nothing has been missed, be as clear as possible and make sure everything on the invoice is fully understood.

Messaging the Manufacturer/Supplier

Here is a very basic example of an initial message you might use when contacting a Manufacturer/Supplier. I probably wouldn't include any more than this initially as you don't want to overload them with questions.

Ask the more detailed questions later on! If they take a long time to respond or fail to answer your questions, this might be a strong indication that they are not the Manufacturers or Suppliers that you want to be working with.

Hi (Name)

I hope you are well.

My name is (your name) and we distribute (product type) to customers across the UK and Europe on Amazon.

I'd be interested in learning more about your (product name)

I'd be very grateful if you could let me know the following:

-Item Size and Weight

-The MOQ (Minimum Order Quantity) plus Prices

-Would it be possible to receive a sample? Plus costs for this

-Are you able to include my logo and barcode on the packaging?

I hope this can be the start of a great Business relationship and I look forward to hearing from you soon.

Best wishes,

(Your Name)

(Your Company Name)

Contacting Graphic Designers to help Develop your new Branding

To 'Private Label' and really make your products "yours" and unique to your new Business then your Business will need a Brand, your Business will need a name, and your products will need labels. Always remember though to check that you have the Intellectual Property rights to sell these products and are not infringing any Trademarks.

If you know a Graphic Designer to develop your logo, branding, packaging etc., then great, but if not then you need to find a designer to work with.

There are freelance designers on websites such as Fiverr.com and PeoplePerhour.com who have experience of product branding and can work with you to create something unique and special to your business. This does not have to cost an arm and a leg, but you need to be clear about what it is you need from the designers.

STEP 2 - SETTING UP AS AN AMAZON SELLER

Amazon Fees & Payments

If you are going to run your Amazon Business effectively, you need to know exactly what you are going to be charged by Amazon for selling your chosen products.

We talked a little about these fees earlier on, but to really get a full understanding of the fees you will be charged and your Profit Margin, Amazon offers a free Profitability Calculator. It is called the 'Amazon FBA Profitability Calculator'.

With this tool, you can search for your product to see if it already exists on Amazon or you can search for a product type that is similar to yours to give you a rough idea of the fees involved.

You can then fill in the information to check the difference in profit, depending on whether you fulfil the orders yourself, or if Amazon is fulfilling the orders for you.

You clearly need to be making a profit and if you're not, then you may need to go back to the Manufacturers/Suppliers and start negotiating harder!

AMAZON PROFITABILITY CALCULATOR EXAMPLE (SELLER CENTRAL PRO ACCOUNT)

This Column shows my Net Profit & Net Margin on each unit if I Fulfil the Orders Myself.

This Column shows my Net Profit & Net Margin on each unit if Amazon fulfils my Products (using FBA).

	Your fulfilment	Amazon Fulfilment
Revenue		
Item price ⓘ	£ 19.99	£ 19.99
Shipping ⓘ	£ 0.00	£ 0.00
Total revenue ⓘ	£ 19.99	£ 19.99
Selling on Amazon fees ⓘ	£ 3.00 ▾	£ 3.00 ▾
Fulfilment cost		
Cost of Seller Fulfilment ⓘ	£ 0.00 ▾	N/A
Fulfilment by Amazon fees ⓘ	N/A	£ 2.44 ▾
Ship to Amazon ⓘ	N/A	£ 0.50
Total fulfilment cost ⓘ	£ 0.00	£ 2.94
Storage cost		
Monthly storage cost per unit ⓘ		£ 0.05
Average inventory units stored ⓘ	1	1
Storage cost per unit sold ⓘ	£ 0.00	£ 0.05
Seller proceeds ⓘ	£ 16.99	£ 14.00
Cost of product ⓘ	£ 4.50	£ 4.50
Net profitability		
Net profit ⓘ	£ 12.49	£ 9.50
Net margin ⓘ	62.48%	47.52%

Setting up your Amazon Seller Account

You will need to decide on the type of Seller you are going to be on Amazon, so weigh up the pros and cons of each type of plan.

If you are taking Amazon Selling seriously then you will probably select a Professional Seller Account (currently £25+vat a month in the UK or \$39.99 in the US) and you pay this monthly fee regardless of how many sales you make.

You also have Referral Fees and Closing Fees on every sale depending on the category your product is listed in. There is also the option of an Individual Account where you are not charged a monthly fee, but you don't have access to the full range of tools on the Seller Platform.

If you do go for an Individual Account, to begin with though, you can always upgrade later!

To get started with your Amazon Seller Account, you will need your contact details, mobile or telephone number, chargeable credit card & valid bank account.

A key point to mention is that you will also need a 'Business Display Name' which will be displayed to Amazon's Customers. This can be changed at a later date, however, if you have some thoughts as to what this should be at this stage it might be worth just jotting them down below.

Remember, when choosing a name, bear in mind that you might be selling a whole range of different products in the future! The use of Trademarks or Proper Names are against Amazon's Policies.

Possible options for My Amazon Business Display Name:

.....
.....

There is another type of Amazon account out there and this is called a 'Vendor Central Account'. Currently, Amazon needs to invite you to use this platform and there are ups and downs to this side, based on my own experience with UK-based Businesses.

From my experience, sellers, typically do prefer the Seller Central Account because they have more flexibility over their products and pricing.

There may come a time though when Amazon invites you to use the Vendor Central Platform and here are a couple of the key differences between the two types of accounts so that you are aware:

- Seller Central is open to anyone, whereas Vendor Central is by Invitation ONLY
- With Seller Central you are selling directly to Amazon's Customers and with Vendor you are selling directly to Amazon

When selling on Amazon it is very important to familiarise yourself with all of Amazon's Selling Policies and Seller Code of Conduct.

Please note that if you sell Handcrafted items you may have the option to register on 'Amazon Handmade'. During the registration process, you register with a Professional Selling plan that provides you with Handmade specific tools and support.

STEP 3 - LEARNING THE AMAZON SELLER PLATFORM

I've mentioned the importance of this part and I can't stress it enough, just how important it is to understand the Amazon Selling Platform. This for me was the biggest frustration originally when doing my research to become an Amazon Seller, many years ago.

So many 'experts' were telling me how great they are and but none of them actually showing me HOW TO SELL ON AMAZON! Whether you have your products ready to sell now or not, you need to understand where everything is on Amazon and there's a lot to it!

Listing your product effectively on Amazon

This is often where people fail at the first hurdle! Remember I said earlier that I have had people on some of my Public Amazon Seminars telling me they have listed their products but didn't get any sales!

Or sometimes I have Business Owners telling me they can't understand why their main competitor is doing so much better than them on Amazon! Well, 9 times out of 10, it is because they just listed the product without doing any research beforehand and their product listing is ultimately quite poor.

On my 'How to Create Your Very Own Amazon Business' on-line training course, I go through how your listing should look to appeal to buyers and achieve sales, so you get things right from the beginning.

Amazon does its best to provide a consistent look and feel to customers in terms of product display, so just remember to check out the 'Product Page Style Guide' to help you write compelling and accurate details in your Category. You can find this in the Help section of your Seller Central Account.

Just a quick point to mention is that for certain Products and Categories, Amazon might require you to obtain approval before listing the product. This may result in additional fees, performance checks etc. Before listing products on Amazon, you should carefully review the Restricted Products policy pages.

If you are selling a product which already exists on Amazon, then it's relatively straightforward. All you really need to do is search for the product name or Barcode from within Seller Central and let Amazon know how many you have to sell, how much you want to sell the product for and you would then 'Compete for the Buy Box' with other Sellers.

For most of us though who are 'Private Labelling' and have our own products to sell, then here are some key points to consider.

Selecting a Product Category

You need to select a Category within Amazon and you want to narrow this down as much as possible to help customers find your product (a good idea is to have a look at the Category in which similar products to yours are listed!).

On Amazon, you have Parent Categories and you have Subcategories. Your product can become an 'Amazon Best Seller' in a Parent Category and/or a Subcategory.

For example, if you are selling outdoor patio chairs, the Parent Category could be 'Garden & Outdoors' but is a Number One Best Seller in Subcategory 'Garden Dining Chairs'. It does tend to be easier to be a Best Seller in a Subcategory.

The Amazon Best Seller Rank updates hourly based on the number of sales.

Creating an Item Name, Features and Product Description

You then need to create a powerful 'Item Name' (basically this is your product name) to make your product stand out and also to identify relevant keywords you want the product to be found for. You also have a section to include 'Product Features', which are usually 5 bullet points at the top of your Amazon listing.

What I like to do here is explain the feature of the product and then turn the feature into a BENEFIT by using the phrase 'which means that'.

For example, *'This Phone has a fantastic camera WHICH MEANS THAT you can take amazing photos of your Amazon Products to maximise sales!'*

You also have a 'Product Description' which is usually located towards the bottom of the Amazon Product Page. I would recommend including some key product information here that you think customers would want to know before purchasing.

You then also have a 'More Details' section where you can include important information such as weight and dimensions of the product.

When uploading the product, any areas highlighted in Red are required fields. Your product ID is your Barcode number. It is possible to request a 'GTIN exemption' if your product doesn't have a barcode, however, this would need to be approved by Amazon. In the long run it is a good idea to Barcode your item. Remember to refer to the 'FBA Product Barcode Requirements' Page in your Seller Central Account to ensure that you are in line with Amazon's requirements

If you're an existing Business and have many products to upload to Amazon, there is the option to 'Add products via Upload'.

Shipping Settings

You need to decide whether you are fulfilling the orders yourself or if Amazon will be doing it for you through FBA (or perhaps you might be fulfilling some products and Amazon might be fulfilling others).

If you are fulfilling the orders yourself, you will need to amend your Shipping Template to reflect your Shipping timescales and costs for Delivery. If you can offer free shipping, & personally I would – it will only help sales!

Include Amazing Photos that Sell!

Photos are how you can really sell your product (Amazon allows up to 9 images in most categories). Your main image should be on a clear, white background and include no logos or text unless it's on the product itself. Really 'sell' your product through images!

On a mobile phone, the images are the first thing you look at and almost dominate the page and many of us purchase on a mobile nowadays!

You can actually buy portable photo studios on Amazon which come complete with portable lights to help you capture professional photographs. In the other images, I would show the product being used and 'In Action'. A professional photographer is the way to go to make your images really look the part!

Competitor Analysis

This is another important part of the process! You need to find your Amazon Competitors and crucially see what you can learn from them and their activities on Amazon as there's no point re-inventing the wheel sometimes.

Your Amazon Competitors are, basically those selling products that are ranked highly (page number 1) for the 'keywords' you want your product to be found for. Interestingly, these are not necessarily the firms you may compete against on a daily basis (if you already have your own Business).

See what you can learn from their product listings. Why do they have so many good reviews? What images have they used? How much are they selling the product for etc.?

Advanced Keyword Research

Keywords are the search terms used to find products on Amazon. Getting this right is a vital part of listing your products effectively and something a lot of Amazon Sellers overlook.

Again, there are tools to help you find the ‘top-performing keywords’ buyers use for your types of products. A favourite of mine is keywordtool.io because it is straightforward to use and there is also a separate Amazon Tab to look for ‘related search terms’ people are searching for specifically on Amazon.

For example, you might be selling Birthday Gifts, so you would search within Keywordtool.io for ‘Birthday Gift’. Keywordtool.io will then suggest other possible keywords to use, along with the Search Volume, which is the average number of times people search for these keywords per month.

You can then include these keywords in your Amazon product listing itself or in the ‘backend’ of your product listing to help your product appear in an Amazon search. They call this Amazon SEO or Amazon Search Engine Optimisation. Similar to what you might do on your website to get to the top of Google.

Without doing some extensive keyword research, there is a good chance your product won’t appear in an Amazon search for terms people are using every day. It is important, however, not to repeat or overload a listing with keywords as this could potentially do more harm than good!

Other possible keyword tools to use could include Google Keyword Planner, SEMRush, Jungle Scout or Merchant Words.

The following example shows where I have searched for ‘Birthday Gift’. Keywordtool.io has then suggested other possible keywords I could use, along with the Search Volume, which is the average number of times people search for these keywords per month (there’s no point using a keyword that nobody is searching for!).

I have selected the 'Amazon' tab.

Google YouTube Bing Amazon eBay Play Store Instagram Twitter

All birthday gift United Kingdom / English

Filter Results Keyword Suggestions Prepositions Sort

Negative Keywords

Search for "birthday gift" found 220 unique keywords

Want to get up to 2x more keywords instead? [Subscribe to Keyword Tool Pro now!](#)

Keywords	Search Volume	Trend
birthday gifts for her	35,000	+172%
birthday gifts for him	15,700	+84%
birthday gifts for mum	8,600	+125%
birthday gifts for men	10,500	+122%
birthday gift for him	15,700	+84%

Keyword suggestions are pulled from Amazon.

Average number of times people search for the exact keyword.

A/B Testing

To improve sales, you can A/B Test or ‘Split Test’ to optimise your product listing. This essentially means that you modify the product listing for a certain time period and monitor your daily sales to see whether sales have increased.

This might include changing the images in your listing, different keywords, the order of your keywords etc. and just make one change at a time.

Pricing Strategy

Pricing is very important on Amazon. You can use tools such as Jungle Scout to help you see the ‘pricing history’ of products similar to yours to give you an idea of what customers on Amazon are willing to spend on your ‘type’ of product.

You can create a Pricing Strategy yourself by analysing competitors’ prices, what customers are willing to spend and make sure you are maximising profitability on each unit.

The website uk.camelcamelcamel.com is a price tracker that monitors products and alerts you when prices of products drop. It is useful for keeping an eye on your competition.

If you do find yourself in the situation of competing for the ‘Buy Box’, you can use the ‘Automate Pricing’ tool to quickly update prices and improve sales conversions. You can manage your pricing from your ‘Pricing Dashboard’ in your Seller Account.

Offering a Business Price on Amazon (Optional)

If your products could be purchased by Businesses, then it may be worth considering offering a dedicated 'Business Price' to Customers who use 'Amazon Business'.

You can also offer quantity discounts to Business Customers.

To offer a Business Price you need to be VAT registered. You will need to provide your tax information to Amazon and the 'VAT Calculation Service' tool automatically generates VAT invoices on your behalf and displays VAT-exclusive prices to Amazon Business Customers.

Amazon Deals & Vouchers

Once you have a Sales History and if you are set up as a Professional Seller, you may have the option to run 'Lightning Deals' which run for a limited time period on the 'Amazon Deals' page. Lightning deals can be a good way to increase sales.

You must, however, be compliant with Amazon's Deals' policies. Another way of increasing your sales is to create 'Digital Vouchers' and offer a discount on your product. Digital Vouchers can be created from within your Seller Account. Buyers can find vouchers on the 'Amazon Vouchers' page and other areas on Amazon.

STEP 4 - FULFILLMENT BY AMAZON (FBA)- MAKING YOUR PRODUCTS ‘PRIME’

If you can distribute your products to the customers yourself, that's fine, but you have also got to think about the practicalities of getting those products to the customers quickly and efficiently! As we went through earlier, people want things *now* on Amazon and they expect top-notch customer service as well as the product delivered to them the next day.

Can you provide that to the customer by fulfilling the orders yourself? If so, great, but if not, you need to think about a more practical way of having your Amazon Business ‘run in the background’ for you.

If you are Private Labelling, you ideally never want to see your products, so you really want them to go straight from the Manufacturer or Supplier to the designated Amazon Fulfilment Centre to be stored and shipped to the customers by Amazon.

So, running things this way will also free up your time and you can generate income from your laptop without even seeing your products.

You need to make sure that your Manufacturer/Supplier is happy with this process and is capable of doing it efficiently.

Your initial first order should be fairly small, just to check that the Manufacturer is performing and that everything ‘checks in’ smoothly.

You can organise a shipment of your products to Amazon from within your Seller Central Account, making them Fulfilled by Amazon (FBA).

When you are ready to send inventory to Amazon, you need to create a 'Shipping Plan' which includes the product that you are sending, the quantity, the shipping method and whether you want to prepare labels for the items yourself, or have Amazon do it for you.

Best of all, doing things this way means in most cases that your products become 'Prime', which means that Amazon Prime customers are most probably eligible for free next day delivery on your product.

FBA Considerations

Your FBA fee is determined by the size and weight of the product so remember to use the 'Amazon FBA Profitability Calculator' to work out your potential FBA Fees.

As your sales start to increase you will need to make sure you can keep up with selling large volumes on Amazon. Not enough products in stock in your FBA Inventory can lead to you losing customers, however, too much stock in your FBA Inventory can lead to storage fees.

Within the Seller Central Account, you can set Replenishment Alerts and these enable you to manage your inventory in Amazon's Fulfilment Centres without needing to constantly monitor each product listing.

Seller Fulfilled Prime

There is another way to make your products 'Prime'.

You can use the ‘Seller Fulfilled Prime’ Service. Seller Fulfilled Prime is the fulfilment programme that allows you to deliver directly to Prime customers, from your own warehouse.

Using this service your products are delivered by Amazon-approved transportation solutions.

There are, however, a number of requirements you need to meet to be eligible for Seller Fulfilled Prime, which currently includes agreeing to Amazon’s Return Policy and shipping over 99% of your orders on time.

You must first go through a trial process to make sure that you are able to meet the requirements for Seller Fulfilled Prime. Once you successfully complete the trial, your product will then be displayed with the ‘Prime’ Logo.

I have a UK-based client that manufactures personalised products and this Seller Fulfilled Prime service works really well for them, as every order they receive is different.

Using this service means that they can personalise each order when it comes in and get it to the customer the next day. The important bit though is that their products are ‘Prime’!

Incidentally, if you do sell customised products and you register as a Professional Seller on Amazon, you can then register to ‘Get Amazon Custom’.

This means that buyers will then have the option to ‘Customise Now’ before adding the product to the basket.

If you sell lightweight products you may have the option to 'Enrol' your Products for 'FBA Small and Light' to possibly reduce your FBA costs.

Things to Consider if you are Fulfilling Orders Yourself

If you don't go down the 'Prime' route, then here are some things to still bear in mind if you are fulfilling the orders yourself.

- Customer service (responding to buyer messages as soon as possible) remember to be as polite and helpful as possible and just remember that you don't want to risk a bad review!

- Check that your Stock Levels match up with the 'Quantity' you have entered in your Amazon Seller Account. Ideally, you don't want to cancel any orders because you don't have enough products in stock, as this can adversely impact on you as a Seller!

- Make sure your Delivery Time is accurate as you don't want to risk bad customer feedback if the customer is expecting to receive the order sooner. E.g. If it could take 5 days to get your product to the customer then make sure this is reflected in your Shipping Template.

- If you are getting a lot of orders every day, you can schedule Order Reports to be emailed to you which will provide you with order and item information, to ensure that you are on top of things.

There is an 'Account Health' page in your Seller Central Account and this provides you with an overview of your performance targets and policies. You can monitor areas such as your Customer Service Performance, Delivery Performance e

To make sure Amazon delivers a great experience to customers, Amazon can take action on these metrics if you do not comply with the targets. It is also a good idea to keep an eye on your 'Performance Notifications' and to look out for important alerts that might affect your Account Health.

As I'm sure you have realised, Prime really is the way to go and many of my clients have increased their Amazon Sales just by making their products 'Prime' either using the FBA (Fulfilment by Amazon) Service or the SFP (Seller Fulfilled Prime) service.

STEP 5 - ADVERTISING & BRANDING

Amazon has its own professional advertising platform built into the Seller Central Account that you can use to help increase your sales when launching a new product or to give things a push from time to time and this can all be managed from your laptop!

In fact, this is where probably many of my long-standing clients spend most of their time. Their products are being fulfilled by Amazon, so the main area to concentrate their time on is the promotion of their products and getting their products seen by all of those Amazon customers out there!

Sponsored Ads

With the Paid Advertising side on Amazon, you pay a fee every time someone clicks onto your Ad, regardless of whether they buy or not.

New Sellers often give me a worried look when I mention adverts-at the thought of spending money. Amazon Ads though are fairly easy to monitor and if the Ads are not generating sales then you can jump in and 'change things' quickly and relatively easily, once you know how and you can also set a maximum daily budget.

You might not use these Paid Ads all the time. They are often really used to get your product seen ahead of the competition and start generating some sales and some great reviews to help your product rank better within an 'organic' Amazon search.

This important advertising tool that is available to you through the Seller Central platform is called ‘Sponsored Ads’. This basically means that your ‘Sponsored Ad’ could appear at the top of a search for a specific keyword or phrase. Why would you do this?

Well, for example, when you first launch your new tennis racket onto Amazon, you might be on page 3 for ‘tennis racket’ in the ‘Organic Listings’ but with sponsored ads you could be seen on the first page immediately and you are charged on a ‘cost per click’ basis.

Once you launch a Sponsored Ads campaign, you will begin bidding against other sellers who are using the same keywords that you have selected! Don’t worry though, you can set a maximum daily budget on how much you are willing to spend!

Manual or Automatic Campaign

When creating a Sponsored Ads Campaign, you can select either a Manual Campaign or an Automatic Campaign.

An Automatic Campaign means that Amazon does the work for you and decides whether your product is relevant to what a customer is searching for. A Manual Campaign, on the other hand, is where you manually enter the keywords you want your product to be found for.

I personally would start with an Automatic Campaign, to begin with, and from there you can download a ‘Search Term Report’ which will show you the actual keywords Amazon customers used to find your product.

You can then use the relevant keywords from this report (and other keywords you want the product to be found for) in a Manual Campaign.

What do 'Sponsored Ads' look like then? Well, they look just like a normal product listing but they have 'Sponsored' next to it!

Managing your Campaigns/Analysing your Sales

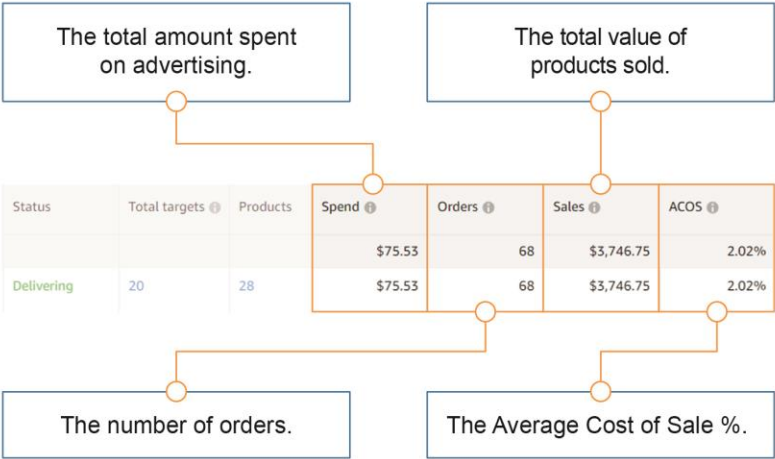
It is very important to keep an eye on your Advertising Campaigns to check that they are generating sales and making you money! You can do this through the 'Advertising' Section in your Amazon Seller Central Account. The key thing to look at here is your ACOS (Advertising Cost of Sale).

The ACOS is calculated by this formula $ACOS = \frac{\text{Ad Spend}}{\text{Sales}} \times 100 (\%)$

So, you want to generate a lot of sales, but you also want a low ACOS, to make sure that you are still making a profit.

For example, after your Amazon Fees and your Shipping Costs are deducted, let's say you are left with a profit margin of 40%. Depending on the client I am working with we would typically tend to be aiming for an ACOS of below 10%.

HERE’S AN EXAMPLE OF A SPONSORED ADS CAMPAIGN AND WHAT TO LOOK FOR



Creating an Amazon Storefront

A Storefront is basically an online e-commerce shop dedicated to your Brand within Amazon.

If you already have a Registered Brand/Trademark, or eventually develop one, then you may have the option to create a 'Storefront' within Amazon to make people more aware of this brand!

Within the 'Insights' of your Store you can track Visitors to your Store and if they purchased your products.

You can also set up 'Source Tags' that allow you to track visitors/sales from other Marketing methods!

Branding your Product Listings/A+ Content

Once you have Registered your Brand with Amazon, then you may also have the option to 'brand' your product listings.

As a brand owner, with A+ Content, you can describe your product features in an advanced way, add detailed descriptions, high-quality images etc. The A+ Content feature is designed to help you increase views on your product listing and ultimately increase sales.

If you do register your Brand with Amazon you can also run 'Brand Ads' in the Advertising section of your Seller Account, these Ads appear on search results and help with brand recognition.

STEP 6 - SOCIAL MEDIA ADVERTISING

Before discovering the power behind Amazon, my 'area of expertise' was always Social Media advertising. I still absolutely love Social Media advertising from a Marketing point of view and have integrated it into many of my Amazon client's Businesses.

Social Media Advertising can be a great, cost-effective way to launch a new product and increase your Amazon Sales.

Facebook & Instagram

OK, so there are two sides to Facebook & Instagram. One is the 'organic' side, which is essentially the 'free' side of these platforms where you can create a Business page or Business profile and try to build your Following by posting content that people find interesting.

People can then engage (like, comment, share) with your content and ultimately this will help with brand recognition and lead to sales. This process, if done right, can be effective, however, it can take a lot of time.

In terms of an Amazon Business though, we are mainly going to use Social Media to drive traffic to our Amazon Listings and generate Sales through paid advertising!

Facebook owns Instagram and therefore you can run Paid Ads on both platforms from 'Facebook Ads Manager'.

You can then target people with these Ads based on their demographics and ‘interests’ (basically what they get up to online) and place an Ad on their Facebook or Instagram newsfeed with an image or video of your ‘fantastic’ new product in front them with a direct link to your Amazon listings.

In some cases, it may be a nice touch for you personally to be the ‘face’ of your Business, in which case you could use videos of you perhaps physically using the product or ‘telling the story’ of your new Business. That’s a great way of promoting a new product on Amazon.

The best bit about these Ads though is that they ‘run in the background’, which means that they don’t take up a lot of your time.

Monitoring your Facebook/Instagram Ads

You may actually only use Social Media Ads for a short period of time just to get the sales moving and good reviews coming in on your Amazon products, which should ultimately lead to your product ranking better organically within Amazon itself.

You might even just use Social Media Ads at certain times of the year, e.g. Christmas Gifts. If managed correctly, Facebook Ads can be very cheap.

If you get your targeting right (and the target audience are clicking through) then the cost per click for these Ads can be very low (even as cheap as £0.01 a click!).

If the cost per click is quite high, then something needs to be changed in your Ad (you can edit the Ad at any time) either the Ad itself or it could be the people you are targeting.

Take a look at the following example I ran previously to one of my own Amazon products.

I spent just under £50 on a pilot campaign and had over 2000 clicks on my Ad which was set up to direct people to my Amazon product.

This resulted in a cost per click of just £0.02. Naturally, if an Ad is working this well, then you will invest more money in the campaign!

The number of clicks to my Amazon Product Listing.		The number of times my Ad was seen (it may have been seen more than once by the same person)		
Results	Reach	Impressions	Cost per Result	Amount Spent
2,096 Link Clicks	27,600	31,777	£0.02 Per Link Click	£48.53 of £48.53
2,096 Link Clicks	27,600 People	31,777 Total	£0.02 Per Link Click	£48.53 Total Spent
The number of people who saw my Ad.		The Cost Per Click.		The number of orders.

Target your Past Customers (If you are an Existing Business)

If you are an existing Business, you can use Social Media Ads, such as Facebook & Instagram Ads, to specifically target your past and current customers.

You could place an ad on their 'Newsfeed', for example, to let them know that you've just launched this fabulous new product on Amazon! You do this by uploading your customer database (email addresses and mobile phone numbers) to the Facebook Ads Manager platform.

Facebook then 'matches' your database with its own. If you are an existing business, you will understand that customers can potentially buy from you again and again...

This data must, of course, comply with relevant Data Protection Regulations eg GDPR and of course, Facebook's own policies.

Target your Website Visitors

If you have a Website or you plan to have a website in the future, then you can even target people who have visited your website with a Social Media Advert! They call this process 'Retargeting'.

If people have visited your website, then there is a good chance they were interested in the products you sell!

Your 'Retargeting' Ads can then direct these people to your product listings on Amazon. To do this, you will just need to add a 'Tracking Pixel' to your website which you can find from within Facebook Ads Manager.

YouTube & YouTube Ads

You could also consider creating your own YouTube channel to promote your business and your fantastic products through videos.

Your long-term goal will be to build up relevant YouTube ‘Subscribers’, so you can keep them up to date with your new product launches.

You could of course, also run YouTube Ads (those annoying Ads you see at the start of a YouTube video!). You could be in these ads personally (if you want to be the face of your Business) or it could be an actor or even an Animation video.

If your skills are limited when it comes to video, you can use freelancers on websites such as Fiverr.com or PeoplePerHour.com to create a video for you!

Finally, it’s important that you monitor your daily Amazon sales when running Social Media Ads to make sure that people are not only clicking onto the Ads, but they are also buying your product as well!

If you sell on other platforms such as eBay, Etsy or you have an e-commerce website then these Social Media advertising skills will help you to increase your sales on these other platforms as well!

Please note that you should only run Social Media Ads on products you have won the ‘Buy Box’ for as you don’t want to give your competitors the sale!

STEP 7 - EXPANDING ACROSS EUROPE & INTERNATIONALLY

So, if sales are going well on Amazon that's great, but what about taking things to the next level? What about expanding across Europe?

When you sign up to be a Professional Amazon Seller in the UK you should also have access to key European platforms which include Germany, France, Italy, Netherlands and Spain. Just think about how many people you could be selling your product to across Europe!

You can use the 'Build International Listings Tool' to automatically transfer your Active UK offers across to the European Marketplaces if the product exists in the other Marketplaces. This tool is very useful for managing your pricing. From my experience I would get your listings professionally translated if you are serious about selling overseas.

Nothing looks more unprofessional than a listing that doesn't make sense! You can use the 'Expand Offers Internationally' tool located within your Seller Central account, have the listings professionally translated (Amazon have a list of trusted local providers to help with the Translation side) and upload your translated product listings via an upload to the appropriate Marketplace.

You can use the same tools I mentioned previously, such as Jungle Scout, to give you an idea if there is a demand for your types of product overseas and then best of all, Amazon can ship your products to these European customers as well through FBA (Fulfilment by Amazon).

When thinking about the FBA (Fulfilment by Amazon) side though, there are a few different options to choose from when fulfilling orders across Europe. You need to decide on which option is right for you.

Amazon also has other marketplaces across the world, so if you follow these ‘7 Proven Steps’, you can be selling your product globally all through Amazon FBA! Having orders shipped through FBA really can mean that you are making money while asleep!

The Amazon Marketplaces currently include:

- US
- Canada
- UK
- Germany
- France
- Italy
- Spain
- Netherlands
- India
- Japan
- Australia
- China
- Brazil
- Mexico
- Turkey
- UAE
- Singapore

Reviews.....

You will of course, in most cases, have to build your 'Reviews' on each platform. There are two types of Reviews.

Firstly, there are 'Product Reviews' which are the reviews customers leave about your products, and there is also 'Customer Feedback', which is how the customer rates you as a seller-basically the 'customer service' side of things.

Using the FBA service, however, means that Amazon takes responsibility for getting the product to the customer. So technically you can't receive bad 'Customer Service' reviews if using FBA.

Great product reviews and great customer feedback will only increase your sales on Amazon!

You can ask customers who have purchased from you on Amazon to leave a review!

Amazon's systems automatically request a review from the customer, however, you can manually 'Request a Review' in your Seller account but in most cases, this must be between 4 and 30 days after the order delivery date.

Just like with all areas of Amazon Selling, when it comes to requesting reviews and contacting customers, it's important that you stick to Amazon's guidelines and policies.

‘Amazon Best Seller’

I just want to mention a couple of final things to look out for when your products start to achieve more sales. Firstly then, the ‘Amazon Best Seller’ rank is calculated based on the sales of a product and is updated hourly.

If your product is ranked Number One, then it means that your product has had more sales than any other product in the category you listed your product in. One of your aims is certainly to get your Product to be a Number One Amazon Best Seller by achieving the most sales!

‘Amazon’s Choice’

You might also see ‘Amazon’s Choice’ on a product listing and this is awarded for being Amazon’s Choice for a certain keyword or phrase. This is basically awarded because buyers who purchased your product were satisfied.

Monitoring your Amazon Sales

There is an advanced ‘Business Reports’ section within your Seller Account that allows you to monitor the number of people who have viewed your product listing, how many units you have sold and your product sales.

You can amend by date range and you can even compare your sales with the previous day/week/year to check that sales are improving.

There you have it, the ‘7 Proven Steps to Becoming a Successful Amazon Seller’

The potential here is huge but clearly will take some work and determination from you to get things going.

I just want to ask you one last question, because I know we’ve been through a lot in this book....

If I was sat down with Alex in 12 months’ time, what would I have wanted my Amazon Business to have achieved? (Sales, Number of Products, Marketplaces etc.) Just jot down a few thoughts below-:

.....
.....
.....
.....
.....

Your 'Amazon Action Plan' to Grow Your Amazon Business

So, what's next?

Well, with this book you will have the tools to help you set up and launch your Amazon Business.

But for those of you who want to maximise this potential right now, I can show you and help you get there quicker with my exclusive and definitive online programme 'How to Create Your Very Own Amazon Business'.

It is available *at an exclusively discounted price*, just for those of you who have purchased this book! Go to the link below for instant online access.

www.amzbusinessacademy.com

It's a really exciting programme as well, loads to go through! I've helped many Businesses to grow using Amazon. Let me help you Create Your Very Own Amazon Business as well, wherever in the world you are based!

At the start of this book, I mentioned the importance of having an Amazon Action Plan. You might be thinking Alex, I just want to get cracking and I understand that but without having a plan of action, believe me, on this one, it is very easy to just lose your way a little and make unnecessary mistakes.

So, included within this book is your very own Amazon Action Plan.

Once completed, you will then have a clear step-by-step Amazon Strategy to grow your Amazon Business. You just need to tailor the actions to suit your situation, change the dates, responsibility (this could be a colleague, wife, husband, son etc.), costs etc. and you will then be ready to launch your very own Amazon Business.

The plan doesn't need to be anything too complicated and this is a VERY basic example of a typical Amazon Action Plan we might put together with a client and of course, is outlined below for guidance only.

I have also included a blank Action Plan for you to include your own Activities, Responsibilities, Timings and Costs.

Please note this Action Plan is indicative of the possible steps which may be required. It is intended that each user will review and modify the Action Plan as required to suit their own individual purposes. It is not meant to be definitive in any way.

Activity	Responsibility	Timing	Cost
STEP 1-FINDING YOUR PRODUCTS			
Research the Market & Find Good Products to Sell	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
Research Amazon Fees on chosen Product Types	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a
Contact Manufacturers to get an idea of minimum quantities and costs to produce, margins etc	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a
Requesting a Sample	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
Contact Designers to design packaging and get an idea of cost	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
STEP 2-SETTING UP AS AN AMAZON SELLER			
Agree go ahead when happy with profit margins/fees etc.	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a
Create an Amazon Seller account- Individual or Professional	Me	To be done by (Date)	Varies
STEP 3 - LEARNING THE AMAZON SELLER PLATFORM			
List agreed Products: • Select a Product Category • Create an Item Name, Features and Product Description • Include Amazing Photos that Sell! • Learn from your Competitors • Advanced Keyword Research	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a
Undertake A/B Testing	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a
Review your Pricing Strategy	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a
Consider Amazon Deals & Vouchers	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a

Activity	Responsibility	Timing	Cost
STEP 4-FULFILMENT BY AMAZON (FBA)-MAKING YOUR PRODUCTS 'PRIME'			
Consider FBA or Seller Fulfilled Prime	Me	To be done by (Date)	Varies
Provide Manufacturer with labels, packaging design etc. (where	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
Monitor Amazon Stock Levels and Account Health	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a
STEP 5-ADVERTISING & BRANDING			
Consider Advertising within Amazon (Sponsored Ads)	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
Placing Sponsored Ads onto Your Competitor's Listings	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
Managing your Campaigns/Analysing your Sales	Me	Ongoing	n/a
Branding your Product Listings/A+ Content, where appropriate	Me	To be done by (Date)	n/a
STEP 6-SOCIAL MEDIA ADVERTISING			
Promote Social Media?	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
Monitoring SM Ads Campaigns	Me	Ongoing	n/a
Target your Past Customers (If you are an Existing Business)	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
Target your Website Visitors	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
YouTube & YouTube Ads	Me	To be done by (Date)	To Be Agreed
Step 7-Expanding Across Europe & Internationally			
Expand into other agreed Marketplaces: US, Canada, Germany, France, Italy, Spain, Netherlands, India, Japan, Australia, China, Brazil, Mexico, Turkey, UAE, Singapore	Me	To be done by (Date)	Varies

Here's your Action Plan... This is for you when you have completed the online training to complete and Launch your new Amazon Business.

Activity	Responsibility	Timing	Cost
STEP 1-FINDING YOUR PRODUCTS			
Research the Market & Find Good Products to Sell			
Research Amazon Fees on chosen Product Types			
Contact Manufacturers to get an idea of minimum quantities and costs to produce, margins etc			
Requesting a Sample			
Contact Designers to design packaging and get an idea of cost			
STEP 2-SETTING UP AS AN AMAZON SELLER			
Agree go ahead when happy with profit margins/fees etc. and			
Create an Amazon Seller UK account- Individual or Professional			
STEP 3 - LEARNING THE AMAZON SELLER PLATFORM			
List agreed Products:			
• Select a Product Category • Create an Item Name, Features and Product Description • Include Amazing Photos that Sell! • Learn from your Competitors • Advanced Keyword Research			
Undertake A/B Testing			
Review your Pricing Strategy			
Consider Amazon Deals & Vouchers			

Activity	Responsibility	Timing	Cost
STEP 4-FULFILMENT BY AMAZON (FBA)-MAKING YOUR PRODUCTS 'PRIME'			
Consider FBA or Seller Fulfilled Prime			
Provide Manufacturer with labels, packaging design etc. (where			
Monitor Amazon Stock Levels and Account Health			
STEP 5-ADVERTISING & BRANDING			
Consider Advertising within Amazon (Sponsored Ads)			
Placing Sponsored Ads onto Your Competitor's Listings			
Managing your Campaigns/Analysing your Sales			
Branding your Product Listings/A+ Content, where appropriate			
STEP 6-SOCIAL MEDIA ADVERTISING			
Promote Social Media?			
Monitoring SM Ads Campaigns			
Target your Past Customers (If you are an Existing Business)			
Target your Website Visitors			
YouTube & YouTube Ads			
Step 7-Expanding Across Europe & Internationally			
Expand into other agreed Marketplaces: US, Canada, Germany, France, Italy, Spain, Netherlands, India, Japan, Australia, China, Brazil, Mexico, Turkey, UAE, Singapore			

Let's get going and create and grow your Amazon Business so that we can help achieve your goal and I look forward to you joining me on my online Amazon Training course below. Thank you so much and let's get started!

Exclusive Online Amazon Training course available at: www.amzbusinessacademy.com

This is what some of the clients I have worked with have said:

'Alex is a great example of someone who is a true expert in their field, he invests time and effort in keeping up with the latest developments and runs his own sales programme so that his advice is strengthened by the reality of day to day management of the Amazon platform. I would highly recommend him to any business wishing to succeed in driving sales on Amazon'

Mark Prince

'I recently attended one of Alex's Amazon FBA Training days and I cannot recommend it highly enough. Alex's depth of knowledge of the Amazon platform & what it takes to successfully sell on Amazon is exceptional. I have done the usual searches on YouTube etc like everyone else but you will never find out all what you need to know from them or the people making ridiculous claims of earnings, but you will with Alex's training, he fully explains in great detail all the requirements from Amazon & for a great product listing and more importantly how to structure that listing & all relevant marketing you will need. Another great thing Alex does is he shows you the phenomenal opportunity that Amazon is, what software to use for product / keyword & competitor research. Best thing of all for me is that Alex is actually doing what he teaches, selling on Amazon. I highly recommend this course, you will not be disappointed'

Darrell Price

'Thank you so much for yesterday's Amazon training. I thoroughly enjoyed it and found it very informative. I have cleared the diary for Friday so that I can load my first products!'

Jayne Maxwell

'It was a great presentation thanks Alex, plenty of information and examples and all questions answered-highly recommended to anyone looking to Amazon or eBay as a platform'

David Rowland

'It was a great pleasure having you teach us how to grow our Business. You are such a gentleman who is very professional. Thank you once again for being of immense help. I can't recommend you enough'

Bukola Ogunbiyi

'The Amazon and eBay Workshops were great! eBay sales increased 161% in just 3 Days since the Workshop. Many thanks for 'turning the lights on' about these valuable sales platforms. Orders with Amazon are already double last month'

C Knowles

'I had already been selling successfully on eBay and wanted to do the same on Amazon. The Amazon Seller platform was not as straight forward as you might think though and I wanted to get things done properly right from the start, that's why I got in touch with Alex. He helped me get set up on Amazon in the UK with his 1-2-1 training, which was really useful and then I asked him back for some further consultancy to launch sales of my products throughout Europe as well. So far I have generated over £100k of sales in just a few short months with lot's more potential for further growth! Many thanks...'

Mayur Patel

***Exclusive Online Training Available at:
www.AmzBusinessAcademy.com***